

Stop Day-1 Churn

Behavioural UX Fix for Leaky Onboarding

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Paid ads get users to click. Your onboarding keeps them.

Today's Talk

01

The Post-Acquisition
State

02

Onboarding Paradigms

03

Root Causes of Day-1
Churn

04

Day1 Retention: How-to



About Me

Behavioural science → product strategy

MSc in Psychology + Game Mechanics + SaaS UX



74-80%

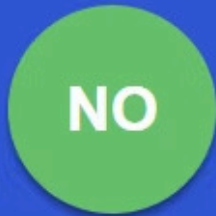
of users will delete you app on Day1



User Inyerface

Hi and welcome to User Inyerface,
a challenging exploration of
user interactions and design patterns.

To play the game, simply fill in the form
as fast and accurate as possible.



Please [click HERE](#) to GO to the next page

Why?

Wrong button colour? 🤔



PART 1

Post-Acquisition User State



They Didn't Download Your App.
They Downloaded a **Promise**.





Perk Ads Create Hostile Evaluators

User as an **Informavore**



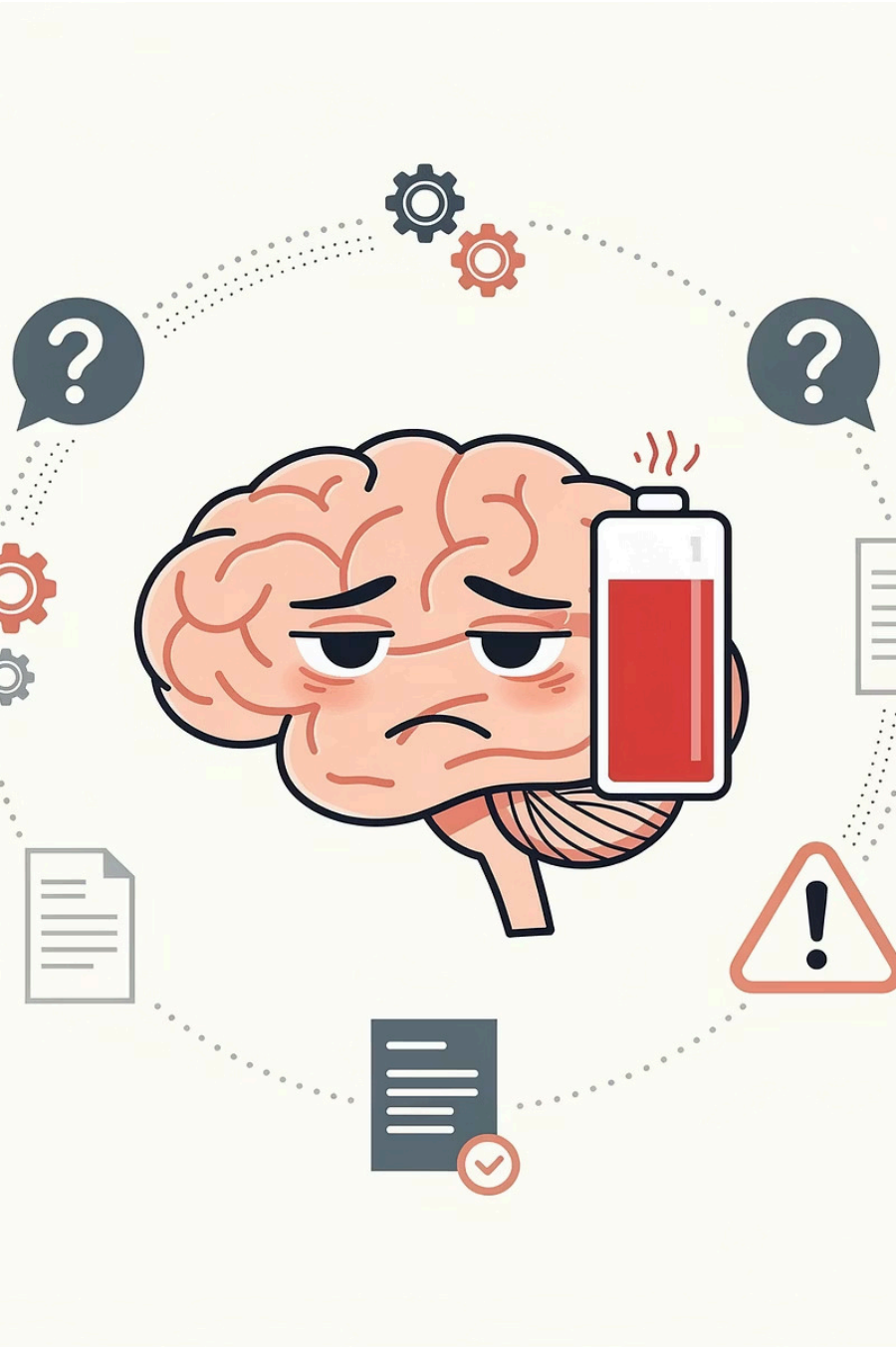


60-Second Threshold

✗ Lengthy registration process



✓ Value first!



PART 2

Onboarding Paradigms

Onboarding Spectrum

1

Forced Walkthrough

2

Contextual Tooltips

3

Progressive Disclosure

4

Self-Directed Exploration

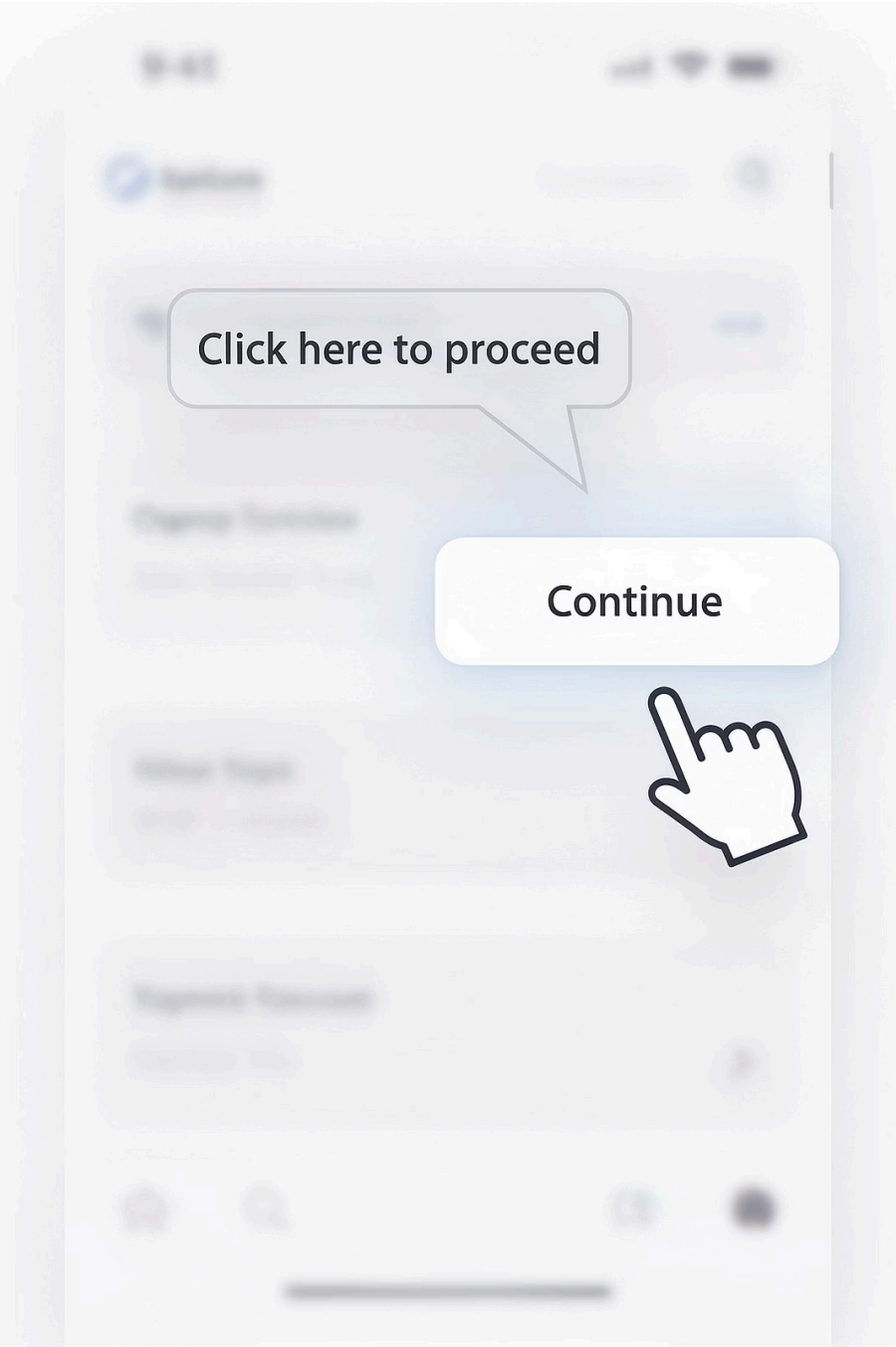


Forced Tutorials: The Worst Offender



Exception: enterprise, healthcare, manufacturing

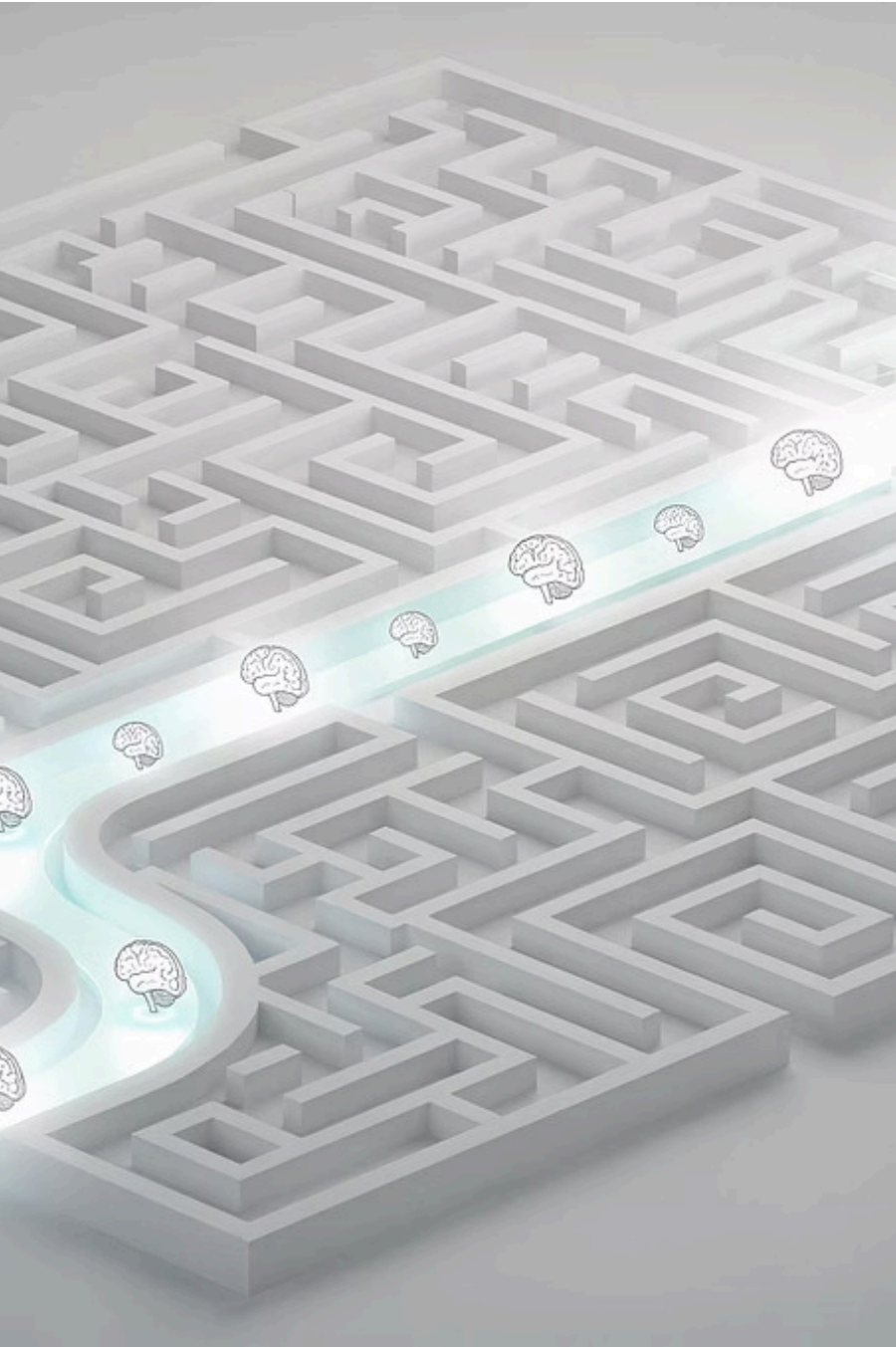
Pull Beats Push. Always.



Onboarding as Contextual
Tooltips: **Helpful Co-Pilot**



Onboarding as Progressive Disclosure: **Training Wheels**



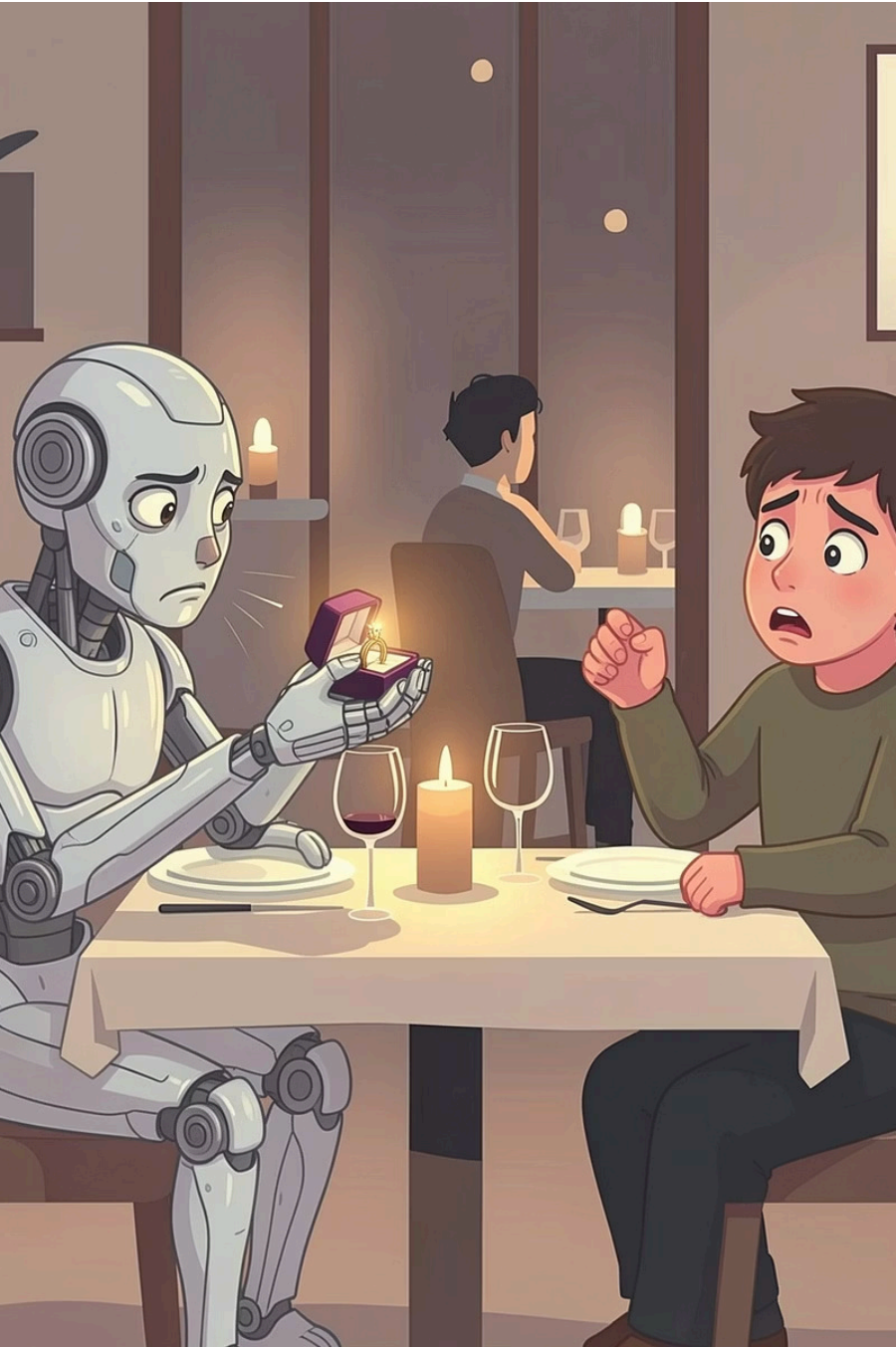
Onboarding as Self-Directed Exploration: **Flow**

Self-Determination Theory Friendly



PART 3

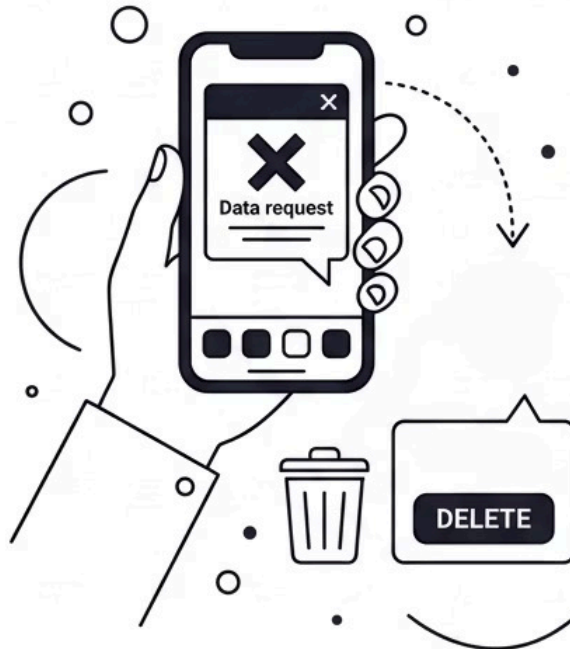
Root Causes of Day-1 Churn



Churn Reason #1:
Sign-Up Wall Kills Trust
Before It's Built

Outcomes

REACTANCE



FATALISTIC CONSENT



Churn Reason #2: Ad Misalignment

**Mobile
game ads**



**The actual
game**





Churn Reason #3: Comparative Mindset

1 Swipe Away From Perfection



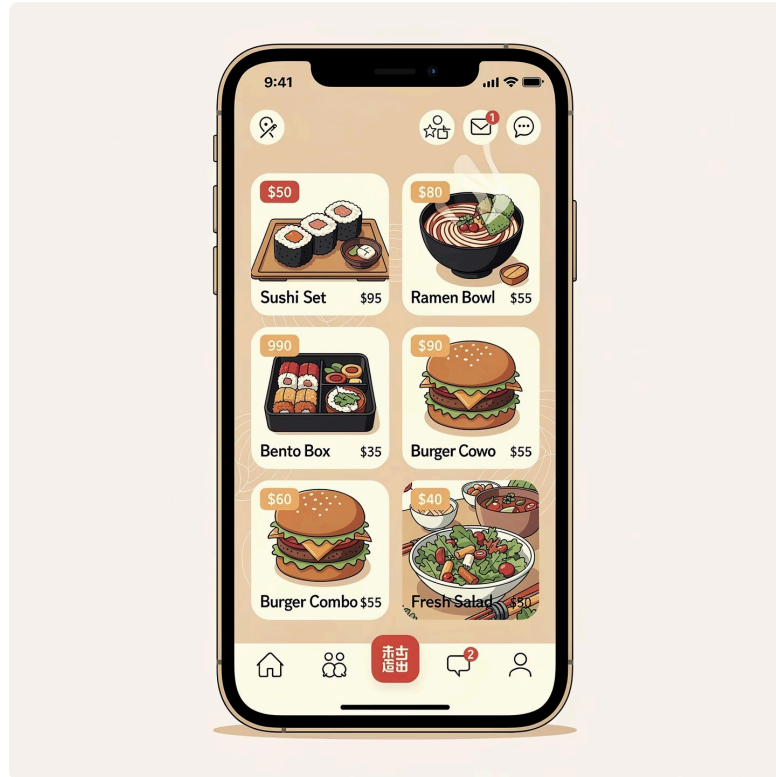
Churn Reason #3: Sensitive Topics and States

PART 4

Day 1 Retention: How To



In a Nutshell: Deliver Core Value Fast! 🕒



Food Delivery App

First value = viewing a menu



Photo Editor

First value = applying the first filter



'Aha!' Moment Neurobiology

The Eureka Effect positively **changes product perception**

Time-to-Value Metric Optimisation

Minimise the Gap →
under 3 minutes leads to **2–3×**
higher Day-7 retention.

Slightly Exceeding
Expectations →
dopaminergic teaching signals

Processing Fluency →
intrinsically rewarding "warm glow"

Minimise the Gap: Anti-Example

HACKAJOB USER REGISTRATION AND ONBOARDING FLOW

hackajob 02.png

hackajob

Hey... welcome to hackajob.

Hey, welcomels to hackajob hev, you sabbric to hackajob, starting psanarange.

CV upload

CV upload field

Upload your hands in this station

Confirm details

You jess xohstates to oclres snobat coltette setuels. Wnd yucrates and aile and confirm your confirm details details.

Confirm

hackajob 04.png

Basic details details?

Full name

Password

Contmt

hackajob 05.png

Location details details?

City

Postcode

Contmt

hackajob 06.png

Phone number details?

Phone number

Conitmt

hackajob 07.png

Desired role selection for you?

Select role

Select role

☐ English

☐ Developans

☐ Noriwern

☐ Developement

☐ Employment

☐ Employees

☐ Dmehiac

hackajob 10.png

Desired role selection for you?

The roles searched for

The roles searching...

Search

hackajob 17.png

Work location preferences or you?

Work location preferences

☒ Onsite

☐ Hybrid

☐ Remote

Commutation warning

7fkr pontaxiellwetoon rnd pzmmaltp. Inswnite povolret one voteny in the parson with the commutation warning.

Submit

hackajob 18.png

Availability and notice period?

Availability

Months

Notice period as availablit?

1

Submit

hackajob 19.png

Contract type selection fie you?

Contract type

☒ Permanent

☐ Contract

☐ Internship

Submit

hackajob 20.png

Diversity and inclusion questionnaire

Which is diversity and inclusion questionnaire?

☒ Permanent

☐ Contract

☐ Internship

☐ Other

Diversity and inclusion

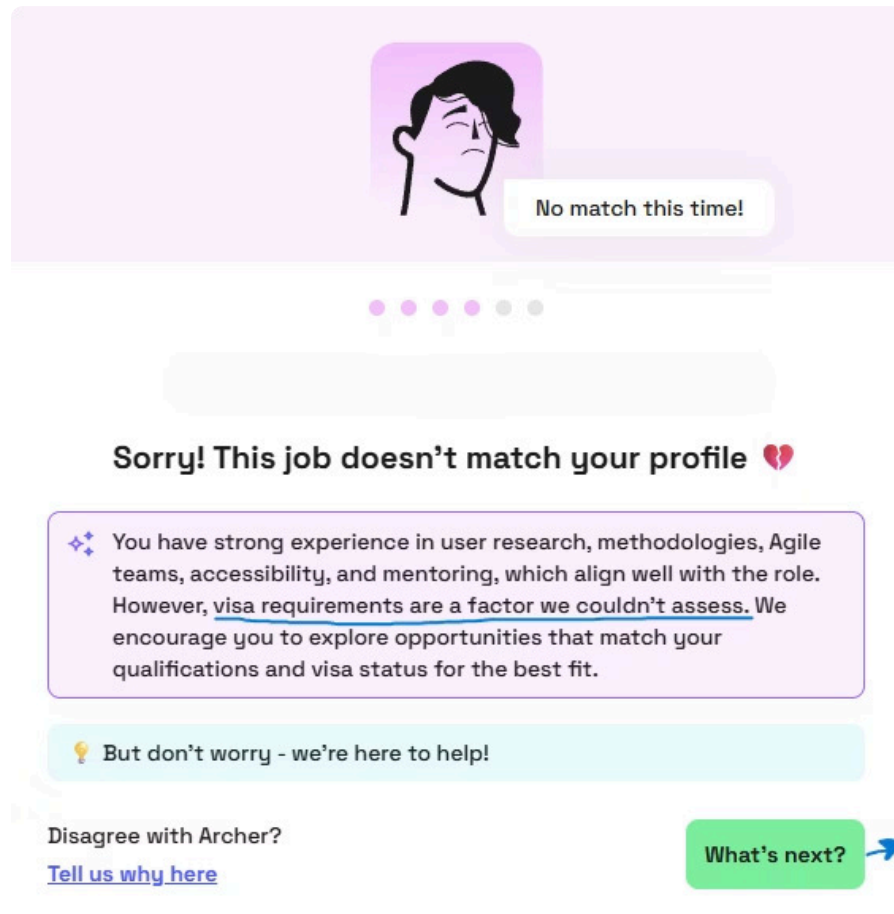
☐ All ose

☐ Other

Back

Next 11

... After **1.5h** onboarding...



What's Next?



... After **1.5h !** onboarding...



...

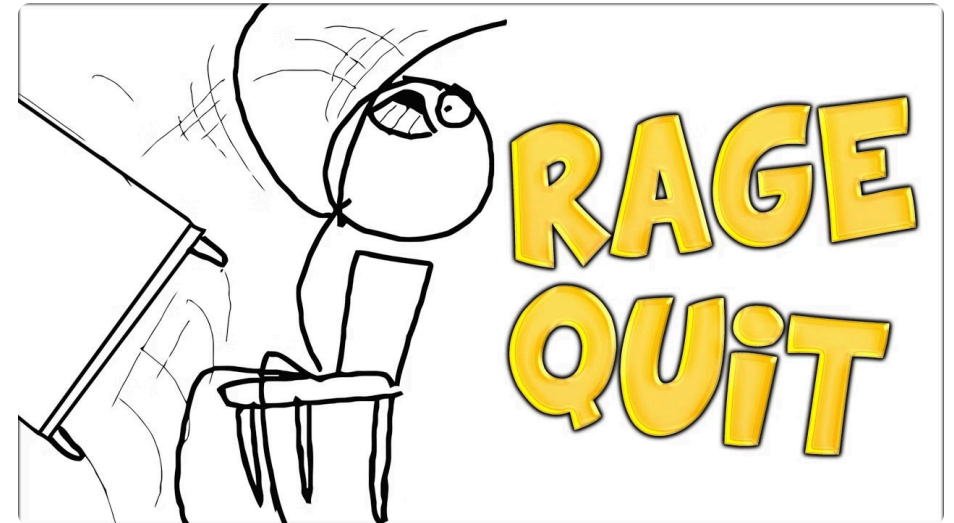
Sorry! This job doesn't match your profile 💔

❖ You have strong experience in user research, methodologies, Agile teams, accessibility, and mentoring, which align well with the role. However, visa requirements are a factor we couldn't assess. We encourage you to explore opportunities that match your qualifications and visa status for the best fit.

💡 But don't worry - we're here to help!

Disagree with Archer?
[Tell us why here](#)

What's next? ➡





Can you spare a cookie?

Sharing your cookies helps us improve site functionality and optimize your experience.

[Click Here](#) to read our cookie policy.

[Manage Settings](#)

Accept

Slightly exceed expectations
at key friction points

How did you hear about us?

You made our marketing team's day 🥳



From a friend or colleague



Internet (newsletter, blog, podcast, etc.)



Search (Google, Bing, etc.)



TikTok



Instagram



Facebook



YouTube



LinkedIn



Other



Done

Slightly exceed expectations
at key friction points

est invariable. Mais il y a une exception à cela : quand un complément d'objet direct (COD) est placé devant l'auxiliaire, le participe passé doit s'accorder avec le COD. Dans cette phrase, *l'* est COD (il remplace le nom *Fifille la chienne* et on dit *voir quelqu'un* sans préposition.) Le participe passé *vu* doit donc s'accorder avec *Fifille la chienne*, au féminin : *vue*.

EN

Regular rule description:

→ 2 ➤ **vus** : Dans cette phrase, le COD *les* est placé avant l'auxiliaire *avoir*. *Les* est un pronom COD pluriel : le participe passé doit donc être au pluriel → *vus*. EN

Slightly exceed
expectations at key
friction points

invariable. Mais il y a une exception à
: quand un complément d'objet direct
(COD) est placé devant l'auxiliaire, le
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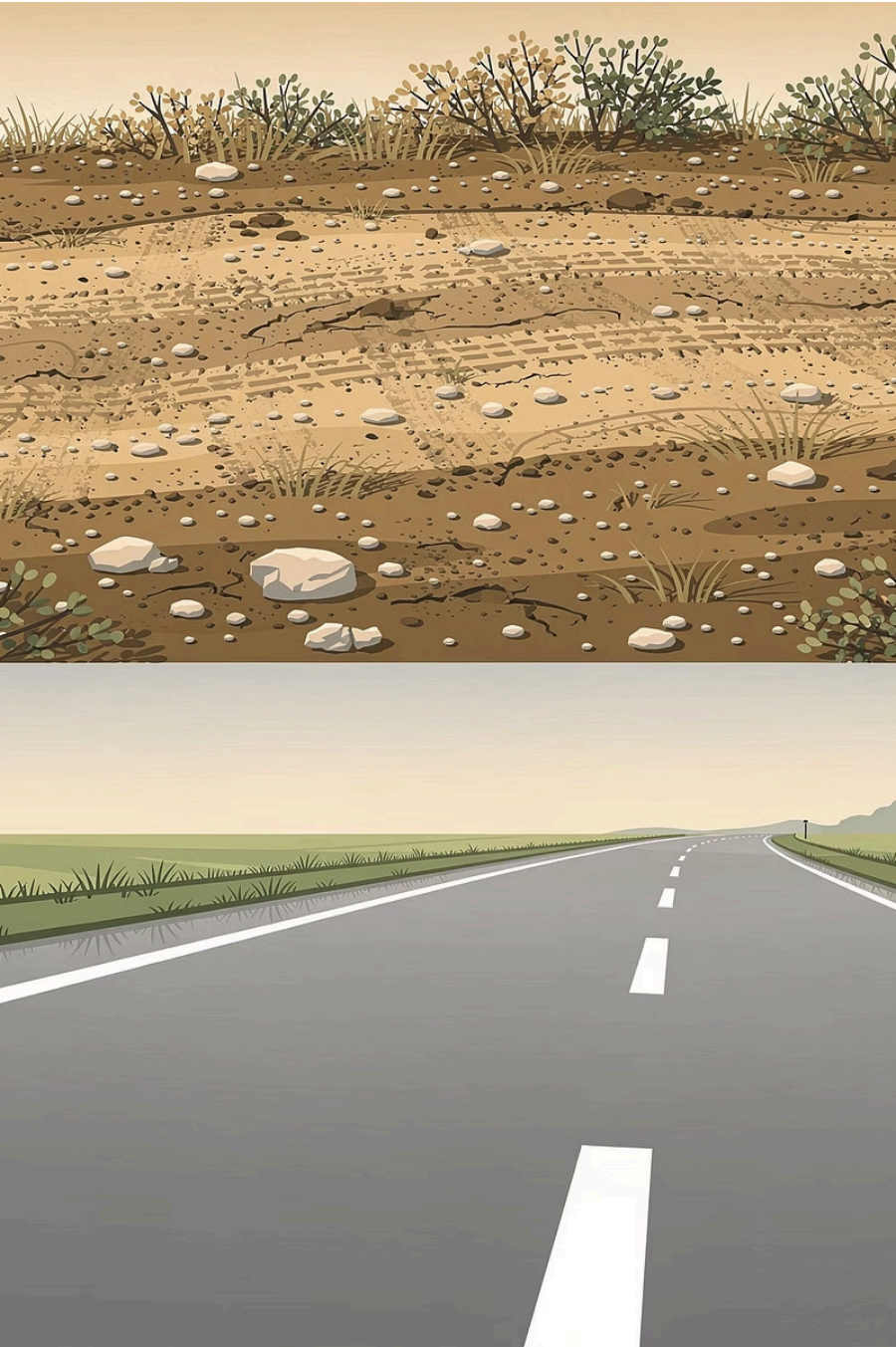
Because the COD *les* (them), which
refers to Fifi and Fille, comes before
the verb, we must make *vu* plural:
comme vous ne les avez jamais vus
(like you've never seen them before).
Note that if both subjects were
feminine, we would change the past
participle to *vues*. I wouldn't blame
you if you stood up and walked away
from your computer right now, Yana.

il donc être au pluriel → *vus*. (EN)

Slightly exceed
expectations at key
friction points

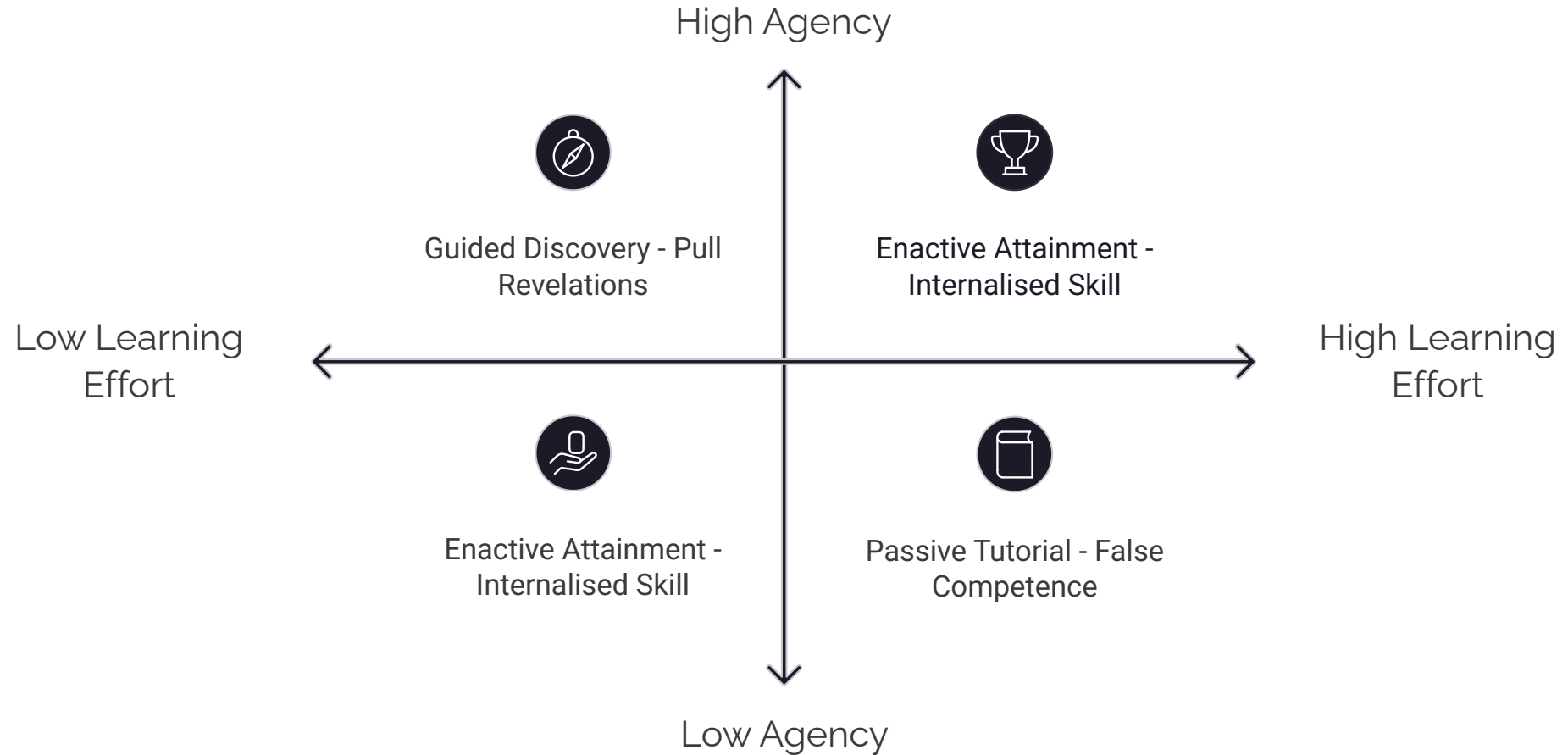
Validating
popup

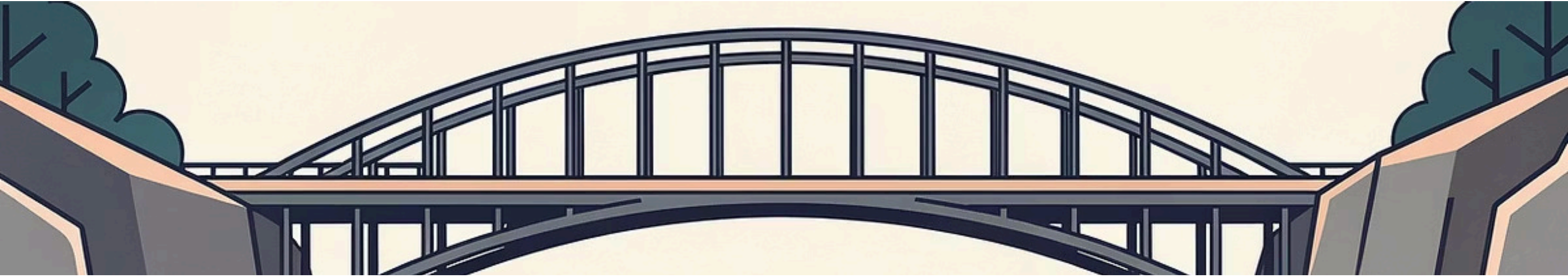




Processing Fluency:
Smooth Road is Your
Invisible Trust Builder

Earning the Win





Call to Action: Architect for the brain, not the brief!



Defer Data Collection



Minimise TTV



Pull Over Push



Match the Ad

LinkedIn Newsletter

